VIT Bhopal University CSE0001 — Digital Literacy Project Report

Student Digital Ambassador Portfolio

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Introduction

In the modern academic and professional landscape, digital literacy is no longer just a technical skill but a fundamental necessity for success. This project serves as a comprehensive portfolio of my journey as a newly appointed Student Digital Ambassador. My primary objective in this role is to bridge the gap between basic computer usage and professional digital citizenship, helping my peers navigate online platforms safely and effectively.

Throughout this project, I have completed five core tasks that map to the essential modules of the Digital Literacy course. These tasks range from designing visual awareness resources and building a professional online presence to mastering cloud collaboration and understanding the complexities of cybercrime prevention. This report documents my technical progress, the tools I have mastered—such as GitHub, Hacker Rank, and Canva—and my reflections on how these digital competencies will support my long-term academic and professional goals at VIT Bhopal University.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used: Canva

Write-up and Reflection: For this first assignment, I took on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador to design a one-page guide for my peers. I decided to use **Canva** because I wanted a professional, sleek look without having to spend hours on manual graphic design. After playing around with a few templates, I settled on a high-tech "Dark Mode" aesthetic—I felt this would really grab the attention of other engineering students who are used to looking at IDEs and dark-themed interfaces.

My infographic focuses on three main areas: a basic **definition of Digital Literacy**, a list of **Useful Digital Tools**, and a checklist for **Safe Internet Practices**. I didn't want it to be a wall of text, so I used icons to represent things like Google Docs for research and a shield for data privacy.

What I found most interesting about this task was realizing how much "hidden" knowledge we take for granted. For example, when I was listing tools like Notion or Zotero, I realized many students might not even know these exist to help with their studies. The hardest part was definitely the word count—trying to explain phishing and two-factor authentication in just a few bullet points was a real challenge. This task taught me that being digitally literate isn't just about using a computer; it’s about knowing how to filter information and stay safe while doing it

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Chosen: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

Reflection and Future Plans: For Task 2, I established my foundational professional digital presence across three key platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I chose **LinkedIn** because it is essential for professional networking, displaying academic credentials, and discovering internship opportunities within the engineering community. **GitHub** was selected to host my technical projects and demonstrate my coding journey to potential recruiters, while **Kaggle** provides a dedicated space to practice data science skills and participate in global competitions.

Setting up these profiles allowed me to understand the importance of a professional online identity. On GitHub, I created a specialized profile README to introduce myself, and on LinkedIn, I updated my education details to reflect my current status at VIT Bhopal University. Over the next four years of my B.Tech journey, I plan to use these platforms as a living portfolio. I will use GitHub to document my semester projects, LinkedIn to connect with industry experts and alumni, and Kaggle to solve real-world data problems to enhance my analytical skills. This foundational setup ensures that I am prepared for the professional expectations of the digital world

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Platforms Used: Hacker Rank, Google Forms, and Google Sheets.

Reflection and Technical Journey: For Task 3, I focused on bridging the gap between technical problem-solving and digital collaboration. As a student in the CSE (AIML) program, I recognized that platforms like **Hacker Rank** are essential for building the algorithmic thinking required for my future career. I didn't just complete a basic task; I pushed myself to earn certifications in **Python (Basic)**, **Problem Solving (Basic)**, and **Problem Solving (Intermediate)**. Solving these challenges taught me how to write efficient code under pressure and helped me move beyond simple syntax to actual logic-based programming.

In the second half of this task, I transitioned to cloud-based collaboration by designing a **"Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz"** using **Google Forms**. My goal was to create a tool that actually helps my peers identify security risks like phishing and poor password habits. By linking the form to a **Google Sheet**, I learned how to automate data collection and organize responses in real-time. This experience showed me how powerful cloud tools are for teamwork and data management.

Mastering these platforms has given me a solid foundation for my B.Tech journey. I now feel much more confident using industry-standard tools to document my progress and collaborate effectively with my batchmates and professors.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Tool Used: Gmail / MS Outlook

1. Professional Email Drafts As part of this task, I developed two professional emails to practice formal digital communication. The first is a request for an assignment deadline extension sent to a professor, and the second is an inquiry to an internship coordinator.

- **Email 1 Subject:** Request for Extension: Digital Literacy Module Assignment - Nesan R-25BAI10212
- **Email 2 Subject:** Inquiry: Summer Internship Opportunity - Nesan R - VIT Bhopal

2. Social Media Do's and Don'ts To promote responsible digital citizenship, I created the following guidelines for college students:

Do's:

- **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Protect your accounts from unauthorized access by adding an extra security layer.
- **Use Professional Profile Pictures:** On platforms like LinkedIn, use a clear headshot to present a professional image to recruiters.
- **Audit Your Privacy Settings:** Regularly check who can see your personal posts and restrict access to trusted friends only.
- **Verify Information:** Always double-check facts or academic news from official sources before sharing or reposting.
- **Network with Industry Professionals:** Use social media to follow companies and professionals in the AIML field to stay updated on trends.

Don'ts:

- **Post Confidential Information:** Never share internal college circulars, exam papers, or private student data.
- **Engage in Cyberbullying:** Avoid aggressive comments, trolling, or any behavior that could be seen as online harassment.
- **Overshare Real-Time Location:** For personal safety, avoid tagging your exact location while you are still there.
- **Use Unprofessional Language:** Avoid using offensive language, slang, or inappropriate symbols in your public bios or comments.

- **Ignore Your Digital Footprint:** Don't post anything that could negatively impact a background check by a future employer.

Communication Scenario and Reflection

The Scenario: The "Reply-All" Academic Grievance A common and damaging situation in digital communication is the improper use of the "Reply-All" function during an emotional or private dispute. For example, consider a student who receives a low grade on a group project and immediately sends an angry, unprofessional rebuttal to the professor. If that student accidentally clicks "Reply-All," their emotional outburst—containing private grievances and perhaps criticism of their teammates—is broadcast to the entire department, including dozens of peers and faculty members.

The Consequences The consequences of this poor digital communication are immediate and severe. It results in a major breach of academic privacy and permanently damages the student's professional reputation among both faculty and future colleagues. As the project brief notes, a short, well-written email is always more effective than a long, poorly structured or emotional one.

What Could Have Been Done Differently

To avoid this, the student should have followed three core rules of digital etiquette:

1. **The "24-Hour Rule":** Never send a professional email while angry; drafting the message and reviewing it later ensures a respectful tone.
2. **Recipient Verification:** Always double-check the "To" and "CC" fields to ensure the message is only going to the intended person.
3. **Tone and Structure:** Using a formal greeting and a clear subject line, as practiced in my email drafts, keeps the conversation focused on the issue rather than personal emotions.

This exercise has taught me that as a Student Digital Ambassador, I must emphasize that digital footprints are permanent, and one click can change how an entire community perceives you.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Write-up and Reflection

While researching the mechanics of phishing and UPI fraud, I was most surprised by how sophisticated "clone" websites and social engineering tactics have become. I previously assumed that a scam site would have obvious spelling errors or poor design, but many modern phishing pages are visually indistinguishable from official banking portals. This process taught me that visual trust is not a reliable way to verify a website's safety.

As a result of this task, the one habit I will personally change is my approach to "urgent" digital notifications. Instead of clicking links provided in SMS or email alerts, I will now manually type the official website address into my browser or use a verified mobile application to check my account status. I also plan to prioritize the use of multi-factor authentication (MFA) across all my academic and financial accounts to ensure an extra layer of security beyond just a password.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy Portfolio has been a transformative experience in understanding my role as a Student Digital Ambassador. Through these five modules, I have transitioned from a passive internet user to an active, professional digital citizen. I now possess the technical skills to manage a GitHub repository, the communication skills to draft professional correspondence, and the critical awareness to identify sophisticated cyber threats.

This project taught me that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but about using them safely, ethically, and strategically. Whether it is collaborating through cloud-based platforms or protecting my financial identity from phishing, these competencies are essential for my academic journey at VIT Bhopal and my future career in the global workforce. I am now better equipped to guide my peers and maintain a permanent, professional digital footprint.

References

- **Canva** (Infographic tool): canva.com
- **GitHub** (Portfolio hosting): github.com
- **Hacker Rank** (Coding practice): hackerrank.com
- **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal**